

# Architecture and Build Report

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## Site Details

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My live Practice Site homepage is at <https://pwoolls1.github.io/WDD331R/index.html> and the source code is at <https://github.com/pwoolls1/WDD331R>.

I chose **Lightning CSS** as my build tool for this assignment.

## Reflection

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*Write a thoughtful response to each prompt. These are not summaries of what you did. They ask you to reason about why your architecture works the way it does and what would happen if it changed.*

## Layer Order

In my `main.css`, I declared the layer order as `tokens`, `base`, `layout`, `components`, and `utilities`. This order moves from the most general styles to the most specific styles. Tokens come first because they define reusable values like colors, spacing, font choices, border radius, and shadows. Base styles come next because they apply to normal HTML elements such as `body`, headings, links, and lists. Layout styles control the structure of the page, components style reusable pieces like cards and buttons, and utilities come last so they can override earlier styles when needed.

If I swapped `components` and `utilities`, some utility classes would stop working the way they are supposed to. For example, a class like `.text-center` should be able to override component alignment when I need it to. If the components layer came after utilities, a component rule could win instead, which would make utilities less reliable. Keeping utilities last makes the system more predictable.

## Token Tracing

One token I defined is `--color-primary`. It is stored in `tokens/colors.css` and is used in several places throughout the site. It affects headings and links in the base styles, button backgrounds in `components/buttons.css`, navigation styling in `components/nav.css`, and temple name/status styling in `components/temple.css`.

If a teammate wanted to change `--color-primary`, they would only need to change it in the token file, but they would need to understand that the change affects many parts of the site at once. This is helpful because it keeps the design consistent, but it could also cause problems if the new color has poor contrast or does not work well with the background, surface, or accent colors. After changing it, they would need to check buttons, links, navigation, headings, and badges to make sure everything is still readable.

## Placement Decisions

One CSS rule I was unsure about was the styling for form elements like `input`, `textarea`, `select`, and `.form-field`. At first, I was not sure if those rules belonged in the base folder because they style HTML elements, or in the components folder because they are part of the form design.

I decided to place them in `components/forms.css` because the rules were not just basic resets. They created a specific form pattern with spacing, borders, and layout. If I later found myself needing the same basic input styles across every page, I could move the more general element styles into `base/elements.css` and keep only the form-specific layout styles in `components/forms.css`. I would know the placement was wrong if the styles affected unrelated pages in unexpected ways or if I had to keep repeating similar form rules in multiple files.